

party applications can tie into this and have one system-wide to-do service where everything is kept track of. There will also be support for RSS in the next version of Mail. It is kind of confusing though. There already is RSS support in Safari, so if Apple added the functionality to Mail too, you are going to have two applications on OS X by default that do different things, but both have support for RSS. Our guess is that the next version of Safari will do away with support for RSS.

5.6.9 Dashboard

Dashboard is one of the absolute favourite features of Tiger for most users. The reason Dashboard has been so great is not only because Apple supplied a good set of starter widgets but because all the developers and users have built so many other fantastic widgets. Apple announced two new features for Dashboard: the first is a feature for developers and the second one for end-users. They announced a new developer tool called Dashcode. It helps you design, develop, and debug your Dashboard widgets. It has a set of templates, which are pre-canned widgets with all the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript you need, and all you do is take and modify them slightly to produce the widget you're looking for. It has templates for countdown, RSS, podcast, photocast, Quartz Composer, daily feed, gauge and custom widgets. Dashcode is also a visual editor for HTML and CSS. So instead of editing the HTML in a text document, you visually lay it out, set the colours, size and everything else and it will produce the HTML and CSS for you. It also ships with a rich Quartz library, so you have everything from search fields to buttons to controls, you drag those out—it has all the JavaScript for those—put it in your widget and you're done. It has a nice JavaScript editor and a full JavaScript debugger.

The next feature, the one for the user, is called Web Clip. Apple has come up with a way where anyone can turn any part of any Web page into a widget. Just visit your favourite site and click the “Open in Dashboard” button in Safari. Dashboard launches a new clip of the site in a customisable widget. From there, you can resize your Web Clip and choose from a handful of window